DATA JOURNALISM & STORYTELLING

Narrative Patterns in the Visual Data Story

How narrative patterns guide readers from understanding PM2.5, to comparing regional change, identifying persistent hotspots, and exploring their own region

Setup

Familiarization + Concretize · Framing & Argumentation

Story Pieces:

- What is PM2.5?
- Why does PM2.5 matter?
- Europe-wide PM2.5 overview map (2024)

OECD Regional Wellbeing

Rising Action

Compare + Gradual Reveal · Argumentation & Flow

Story Pieces:

- PM2.5 change from 2007–2024
- Comparison of regional improvement
- West vs East improvement gap

Bloomberg climate visuals

Climax

Emphasis · Emotion & Flow

Story Pieces:

- Persistent pollution hotspots
- Northern Italy hotspot
- Balkan and Central European hotspots

Periscopic "U.S. Gun Deaths"

Resolution

Recap · Engagement

Story Pieces:

- Explore your own country
- Compare regions
- Reader-driven investigation

New York Times interactives